

Element I: Testing, Data Collection and Analysis

The development office at our independent boarding and day school has an overflow of items. The excess items piled on the floor hinder workflow and efficiency. Many items move around the development office; therefore, it is important to keep them organized. The current storage situation is unsatisfactory in the eyes of school donors and visitors.

Our tests were designed to address several high-priority design requirements, however, the most important were accessing outlets, concealing boxes, and storing office supplies. To assess the accessibility of outlets, we measure the distance of the outlets to the wall and compare it to our design. We measured all items needing storage (boxes, bins, supplies) and calculated their combined volume to determine the necessary shelf space. If needed this information would allow us to adjust our design to meet the high priority design requirements.

Item	Measurement	Will it fit?
Outlet	From wall 51 in From floor 13.5 in	It will not be obstructed by the shelf
Storage tote	20in x 15in x 14in	It will fit in left bottom section, or right shelves
Envelope boxes	15in x 3in x 8.5in	It will fit on the right shelves
Filing cabinet	16in x 22in x 20in	It will fit under the left shelf

This data shows us that the items that will be stored will all fit into the prototype, and there will still be extra room for other stored items. The prototype also will not obstruct the outlet. The doors will be able to close without colliding with items on the shelf.